

Appointment Cancellation & No-Show Policy

Purpose

This policy outlines the procedures for handling appointment cancellations and no-shows in ClinicDesk. Consistent enforcement protects the clinic's schedule and revenue while maintaining fair treatment of patients.

Cancellation Window

Patients must cancel or reschedule at least 24 hours before their scheduled appointment. Cancellations made within 24 hours are considered late cancellations.

Late Cancellation Fee

A \$25 late cancellation fee is automatically applied to the patient's account. Staff can apply this fee through: Patient > Billing > Fee Adjustments > Add Fee > select "Late Cancellation" from the fee type dropdown.

No-Show Fee

Patients who do not arrive within 15 minutes of their scheduled time are marked as no-shows. The full visit amount is charged. To mark a no-show: Scheduling > Daily View > right-click the appointment > Mark as No-Show. The fee is applied automatically.

Fee Waiver Policy

Staff may waive the cancellation or no-show fee once per patient per calendar year. To waive: Patient > Billing > Fee Adjustments > select the fee > click "Waive" > enter reason. Waivers require a documented reason (e.g., medical emergency, weather event).

Repeat Offenders

Patients with 3 or more no-shows within 12 months are flagged automatically. A yellow warning icon appears next to their name in the scheduling view. The office manager receives a weekly report of flagged patients via Reports > Patient Compliance > No-Show Report.

Configuring the Policy

To adjust the cancellation window or fee amounts: Settings > Practice Policies > Cancellation Policy. Changes apply to appointments created after the policy update. Existing appointments retain the policy that was active when they were booked.